Lab 41 — Mobile & Endpoint Hardening Baseline

The learner applies a hardening baseline to a Linux endpoint (the stand-in for a managed mobile/endpoint), disabling weak services and enforcing policy, then verifies it.

Run on https://killercoda.com/playgrounds/scenario/ubuntu

Objective: Apply and verify an endpoint hardening baseline

You'll build: A hardened host with password policy, disabled root SSH, and a screen-lock/idle-timeout policy — verified against a checklist.

Tools: sshd_config, login.defs, pam, systemctl

Step 1 — Enforce a minimum password age/length policy

```
sed -i "s/^PASS_MIN_LEN.*/PASS_MIN_LEN 12/" /etc/login.defs
2>/dev/null; grep PASS_ /etc/login.defs
```

Step 2 — Disable direct root SSH login

```
sed -i "s/^#*PermitRootLogin.*/PermitRootLogin no/"
/etc/ssh/sshd_config
```

Step 3 — Set an idle session timeout

```
echo "TMOUT=600; readonly TMOUT" > /etc/profile.d/timeout.sh
```

Step 4 — Disable an unneeded service

```
systemctl disable --now avahi-daemon 2>/dev/null; echo done
```

Step 5 — Verify the baseline against a checklist

```
grep PermitRootLogin /etc/ssh/sshd_config && cat
/etc/profile.d/timeout.sh
```

Verify

Root SSH login is disabled, the password policy is set, and the idle-timeout policy is present.